

Inventions

Inventions and discoveries have changed the course of our history.



Wheel (3,500 BCE) The first known wheel was used in Mesopotamia.



Paper (50 BCE) This was invented in China, but kept secret for many years.



Compass (1190) The magnetic compass was first used by the Chinese.



Parachute (1783) The first one flew centuries after Leonardo made his drawings.



Steam train (1829) The earliest successful model reached 48 kph (30 mph).



Colour photo (1861) First produced by physicist James Clerk Maxwell.

Did you know?

More than 2,000 years ago, Greek thinker Aristotle recommended that people look at nature, and carry out experiments to test ideas.

A kite helped Benjamin Franklin learn about lightning and electricity.

Benjamin Franklin (1706–1790)

American scientist Benjamin Franklin experimented with lightning and electricity. His work in the 1700s laid the foundations for today's electrical world.



Franklin risked his life flying a kite in a storm.

Louis Pasteur (1822–1895)

Best known for discovering pasteurization (a process that uses heat to destroy bacteria in food, particularly milk), Pasteur also discovered that some diseases were caused by germs. He encouraged hospitals to be very clean to stop germs spreading.

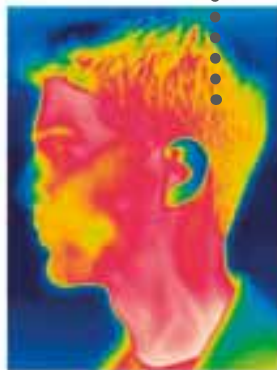


1700

1800

William Herschel (1738–1822)

Herschel is well known for his work in astronomy (he first identified the planet Uranus). He also discovered infrared radiation – this technology is used today for wireless communications, night vision, weather forecasting, and astronomy.



Wilhelm Conrad Röntgen (1845–1923)

Röntgen discovered electromagnetic rays (known today as x-rays) on November 8th, 1895. His important discovery earned him the first Nobel Prize in Physics in 1901.

X-rays allow doctors to look inside the human body.

